

NovaTech Solutions

Leave & Absence Policy

Entitlements, Procedures & Approval Guidelines

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Leave Policy Overview

NovaTech Solutions is committed to ensuring employees can maintain a healthy work-life balance. This policy outlines all leave entitlements, how to apply for leave, and manager responsibilities. All leave requests must be submitted via the HR Portal (hr.novatech.io) unless otherwise stated.

Leave Type	Entitlement	Paid?	Notice Required
Annual Leave	25 days/year (+2 after 3 yrs, +3 after 5 yrs)	Yes	5 working days
Sick Leave	15 days/year (uncapped accumulation up to 45)	Yes	Same day by 9 AM
Maternity Leave	90 days (60 fully paid + 30 at 50% pay)	Partial	8 weeks before EDD
Paternity Leave	10 days (must be taken within 30 days of birth)	Yes	4 weeks before due
Bereavement Leave	5 days (immediate family) / 3 days (extended)	Yes	ASAP
Study / Exam Leave	Up to 5 days/year per approved qualification	Yes	2 weeks
Unpaid Leave	Up to 30 days/year (discretionary)	No	4 weeks
Compassionate Leave	Up to 3 days per incident	Yes	ASAP

1. Annual Leave

All full-time permanent employees accrue 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Entitlement increases to **27 days after 3 years** and **30 days after 5 years** of continuous service.

Leave is accrued monthly (approx. 2.08 days/month). Employees joining mid-year receive a pro-rated entitlement. A maximum of **10 days may be carried over** to the next calendar year; any unused days above this threshold are forfeited.

- Leave requests must be submitted at least 5 working days in advance via the HR Portal.
- Managers must approve or decline requests within 3 working days of submission.

- No more than 20 consecutive days may be taken at once without Head of Department sign-off.
- Annual leave cannot be taken during the first 3 months of employment — use carries to Month 4+.
- Leave encashment (paying out unused leave) is not permitted except on resignation or termination.

Note: During busy periods (e.g. year-end close, major product launches), the relevant Head of Department may impose a leave freeze of up to 4 weeks with 2 weeks' prior notice to affected employees.

2. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to **15 days of paid sick leave per year**. Unused sick leave accumulates up to a lifetime maximum of 45 days. Sick leave beyond 3 consecutive days requires a medical certificate from a licensed physician.

If an employee exhausts their paid sick leave balance, additional sick days will be unpaid. After 30 consecutive days of sick leave, HR will initiate a welfare review and may consult with the employee's physician.

- Call your line manager or send a message before 9:00 AM on the first day of absence.
- Self-certification is acceptable for 1-3 days per incident (maximum 2 self-certified absences per quarter).
- Sick leave taken immediately before or after a public holiday may require a medical certificate.
- Abuse of sick leave (pattern of Monday/Friday absences, etc.) may lead to a formal investigation.

3. Maternity Leave

Eligible employees (employed for at least 6 months at the expected delivery date) are entitled to **90 days of maternity leave**: 60 days at full pay and 30 days at 50% of basic salary.

Employees must notify HR at least **8 weeks before the expected delivery date (EDD)** and provide a medical certificate confirming the EDD. Leave may commence up to 4 weeks before the EDD or earlier if medically advised.

- Employees may opt to take KIT (Keeping in Touch) days — up to 10 days of work during maternity leave without losing entitlement.
- On return, the employee is entitled to return to the same or equivalent role.
- Flexible return-to-work arrangements (phased return, temporary part-time) may be agreed with HR and the line manager.
- Breastfeeding rooms are available in all NovaTech offices.

4. Bereavement Leave

NovaTech recognises that the loss of a loved one is an intensely personal time. Bereavement leave is granted as follows:

- 5 days paid leave for the death of a spouse, child, parent, or sibling.
- 3 days paid leave for the death of a grandparent, in-law, or close relative.
- 1 day paid leave to attend the funeral of a close friend or colleague (line manager discretion).

- Additional unpaid leave of up to 5 days may be requested and is granted at the manager's discretion.
- Travel time is not included in the leave entitlement; employees may request an additional day if international travel is required.

5. Study & Exam Leave

NovaTech encourages continuous learning. Employees enrolled in an approved professional qualification may apply for up to **5 study/exam days per year**. Approval is subject to operational requirements.

- The qualification must be relevant to the employee's current or target role at NovaTech.
- Evidence of enrolment and exam dates must be submitted at least 2 weeks in advance.
- Proof of completion (exam result, certificate) must be submitted to HR within 30 days of the exam.
- If the employee leaves within 12 months of using study leave, NovaTech may recover the cost of any training fees paid.